

Elroy Saltzherr

Redwood City, California | 650-670-7875 | lsaltzherr@gmail.com

[LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#) | [Portfolio](#)

Professional Summary

Game Designer specializing in game mechanics, scripting, and iterative design. Experienced in progression systems, encounter balancing, and meta-game tuning through rapid prototyping and data analysis. Published developer of Dark Throne on Steam, focusing on systems design, player engagement, and live iteration. Passionate about crafting dynamic, replayable gameplay loops that adapt to player strategies.

Game Development Experience

Steam Game (Dark Throne)

Game Designer & Lead Developer | Mar 2024 – Jun 2024

- Designed and balanced progression, combat pacing, and AI behaviors for a published 2D action game.
- Developed modular upgrade mechanics, resource systems, and encounter difficulty tuning.
- Conducted iterative playtesting and data-driven balancing using Google Sheets & SQL.
- Worked with player feedback to refine meta-game elements and enhance engagement.

Browser-Based Games(Where's My Gun? & Pencil Pusher)

Game Developer | Apr 2022 – Jun 2022

- Designed core gameplay loops, player abilities, and encounter structures.
- Iterated on difficulty tuning and challenge scaling based on player feedback.
- Prototyped mechanics and UI interactions using JavaScript & Phaser.js.

Game Jams (Solo Projects)

Game Designer & Solo Developer | Various Dates

- Created progression systems, procedural mechanics, and strategy-based gameplay loops.
 - Experimented with Unreal Engine Blueprints for small-scale interactions and UI flow.
 - Iterated on mechanics using C# and JavaScript, refining balance through playtesting.
-

Additional Experience

Online Store Automation Project (Etsy)

Freelance Developer | Jun 2023 – Feb 2024

- Designed Python automation scripts to streamline e-commerce workflows, reducing manual effort.
- Worked directly with a store owner, iterating on solutions to improve usability and efficiency.
- Debugged and optimized scripts based on user feedback, ensuring seamless automation.

Robotics Team (FRC Team 199 Deep Blue)

Team Member & Project Lead | Sep 2016 – Mar 2020

- Specialized in game mechanics, progression systems, and interactive storytelling.
 - Developed game prototypes, iterating based on playtesting and engagement data.
-

Education

Bachelor of Science in Game Design

University of California, Santa Cruz | Sep 2020 – Jun 2024

- Focused on game mechanics, level design, and interactive storytelling.
 - Developed proficiency in prototyping gameplay systems and collaborating on team projects.
-

Skills

- Game Design: Progression Systems, Game Balance, Meta-Game Design, Player Retention, Encounter Design
 - Scripting & Tools: Google Sheets (Data Balancing), SQL, Python (Scripting & Automation), Unreal Engine (Blueprints), JavaScript
 - Technical Skills: C#, JavaScript, C++, Unity, Phaser.js, Excel (Game Data Analysis & Tuning)
 - Soft Skills: Data-Driven Design, Playtesting & Iteration, Cross-Team Collaboration
-

Achievements & Projects

- Published Dark Throne on Steam – Designed and balanced core gameplay systems, optimizing player engagement.
- Iterative Design in Browser Games – Refined game balance, enemy AI, and progression loops through playtesting.
- Game Jams Participation – Developed systems-focused mechanics and adaptive gameplay under strict deadlines.